

Product Manager — DragonCandy

You would be our first product hire, and you start by finding out what we actually have.

Location: United States, or working US hours. Our customers are American restaurant owners.

Engagement: Paid two-week trial → 6-month contract → extend or convert to permanent. **Start:** Target Q4 2026. You start before the developers do. **Reports to:** Dame Williams, co-founder & CTO.

The company

DragonCandy connects businesses with content creators. A restaurant gets a social media team without hiring one. A creator gets real paid partnerships instead of chasing gig apps. Our built-in AI, **Donny**, writes the campaigns, matches the right people, and schedules and publishes the posts.

The product is live at dragoncandy.com. We are pre-revenue by choice, with about 30 organic users and no launch date set yet.

One person has built all of it, and nobody has ever audited it as a product. That is your first job.

The honest situation

We have 92 screens serving three completely different kinds of user — businesses, creators and brands. Features have been built, half-built, and in a few cases built and forgotten. Nobody has ever sat down and gone through the whole thing asking "does this work, and does it make sense?"

That is not a criticism of the person who built it. It is what happens when one engineer builds a marketplace alone. But it means we genuinely do not have a reliable list of what exists and what state it is in.

You would be the person who finds out. If that sounds like cleanup rather than product work, it is worth saying that the audit is how you will earn the right to set the roadmap — and the roadmap is yours afterwards.

What you'd own

- **The audit** — the first 30 days, described below.
 - **The backlog.** What gets built, in what order, and why.
 - **The developer roadmap**, taken off Dame gradually and deliberately.
 - **The designers.** You manage the design work as well as the engineering roadmap.
 - **Writing specifications a developer can build from without a meeting.**
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What we need

Required

- **Marketplace or two-sided platform experience.** Buyers and sellers, or supply and demand. Balancing two user groups with opposing interests is the core of this product and it is a learned skill.
- **Technical enough to push back on engineers.** You do not need to write code. You do need to know when "that's hard" means "that's hard" and when it means "I'd rather not."
- **You write clearly.** Our team spans the US and Europe with three hours of overlap a day. Most decisions happen in writing. A specification that needs a meeting to explain it has failed.
- **You can talk to small business owners.** Our users are restaurant owners, not product managers. If you cannot sit in a restaurant and hear what is actually wrong, you cannot do this job.
- **Comfortable with AI tools** — we use Claude and Codex throughout, including for writing and research.

Bonus

- Creator economy, social media, or hospitality experience
 - You have run a product audit before
 - Basic SQL — enough to answer your own questions
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The first 90 days

Weeks 1–2 — paid trial. A scoped slice of the audit, on real screens. Paid at full rate.

Days 1–30 — the audit. Go through every feature, for all three types of user, and write down: what exists, what is broken, what is confusing, what is unfinished, and **what should be deleted**. That last one matters as much as the others.

The output is one prioritised backlog in Linear. Every item must be reproducible by someone who is not you — a developer joining on day 30 has to be able to pick it up and understand it cold.

Target: at least 40 triaged items.

Days 30–60. The developers arrive. You turn the backlog into work, write the specifications, and run the two-week cycles.

Days 60–90. Continuous delivery of audit fixes, plus the two things blocking our launch: content delivery and payments.

How we work

- **Two-week cycles.** Monday planning, Friday demo. Ceremony kept minimal on purpose.
- **Linear** for tickets, synced with GitHub. Every ticket names the user type, the screen size, and how we will know it works.

- **Written and asynchronous by default.** Roughly three hours of live overlap with Europe daily.
 - **Done means done:** merged, checked on phone and desktop, verified in production.
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The guiding rule you will be measured against

Less typing = more margin. Every main task should take fewer than ten keystrokes. We prefer voice, then camera, then pasting a link, then tapping a button. Typing is the last resort. Our target is a paid campaign live in under 60 seconds.

If a feature makes a restaurant owner type when a tap would do, it is wrong — regardless of how well it is built.

Why take this job

You would be the first product person at a company with a real, large, working product and no product function at all. There is no existing roadmap to inherit or defend. You will decide what this becomes.

The honest risks: pre-revenue, no launch date, and a founder who has held the product vision alone for two years and is handing it over on purpose. That handover is real, and it is also going to take some care from both sides.

Applying

Send a CV and one example of a product decision you made that turned out to be wrong, and what you did next. Include your salary expectation in the first message.